

Mary Jane's Last Dance -- Tom Petty

Tom Petty and the Heartbreakers, 1993, from *Greatest Hits*. About 84 BPM, est.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

The bass locks to the kick under the A minor riff. Steady eighths and quarters, with a lot of weight on the root. It's a heartland rock tone: punchy and mid-forward, with no hi-fi sparkle.

Pick or fingers both work. A pick gets closer to the driving attack. Blend both pickups with the P slightly louder.

Tone knob around 60%.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg810 IR (User IR 3)

An SVT into an 8x10 is the classic rock bass rig. It has the midrange push this groove needs to sit between the kick and the AC30-style guitars.

Apg810 is the most direct real-world pairing for Classic Bass in the loaded set.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 15. Catches hum when you stop. Gain is low, so it doesn't need to work hard.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 40, VOL: 58.

Keeps the eighth-note drive even across the bar so the groove doesn't lurch.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 25, Blend: 30, VOL: 55, Bass: 50, Treble: 50.

A light hair on top for the choruses and outro. Blend 30 keeps the clean low end intact and adds grit only in the mids.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 30, Bass: 55, Middle: 55, MidFreq: 450Hz, Treble: 48, VOL: 65.

A bit of SVT warmth at gain 30. Middle 55 at 450Hz gives the note body so it reads on small speakers.

CAB -- User IR 3 (Apg810), always on. VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: 0, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: -1, 800Hz: +2, 4.5kHz: -2, VOL: 52.

Punch at 120Hz, a small scoop at 400Hz to clear mud, and +2 at 800Hz for attack definition. The top is trimmed.

MOD -- off. DLY -- off. RVB -- off. Dry and tight like the record's rhythm section.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Bass OD).

- **CTL off** -- Verses and the main riff. Clean, punchy SVT. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on** -- Choruses ("Last dance with Mary Jane") and the outro. A light Bass OD grit pushes the bass forward with the fuller band.

Engage it at the choruses and for the outro jam. Step off for the verses.